does lm areana provide free api ?

No, LM Arena (now rebranded as Arena.ai) does not provide a free developer API for running inference or building external applications.

While the platform offers **100% free, unlimited access to premium AI models** through its web interface—including Battle Mode and Direct Chat—this is designed purely for human preference testing and benchmarking. YouTube · Coding Shiks... +2

Here is how Arena.ai handles access and developer tools:

- **Free Web Tooling:** You can manually test snippets, text, images, and videos on the Arena.ai Web Platform completely free without an account. Developers often use this to test prompts across multiple models side-by-side before committing to a paid provider. YouTube +1
- **Commercial Enterprise API:** For businesses and developers requiring API or SDK integrations, Arena.ai offers **paid, custom-priced enterprise services**. These commercial tiers include private evaluation arenas, proprietary dataset testing, and analytics dashboards.
- **Free Public Datasets:** If you are a researcher, they do provide free access to their open-source repository of human preference data and benchmarks on Hugging Face.

If you need a free API to build projects, you can look into alternative platforms like Google AI Studio (for free tiers of Gemini models) or OpenRouter, which provides free API keys for selected open-weights models.

If you are looking for free ways to build your project, let me know:

Ask anything

AI can make mistakes, so double-check responses

Try without personalization

i want free api for my whatsapp agent to reply customers

Yes, you can build a WhatsApp agent using free API tiers, but because Meta charges for official WhatsApp Business API messages, you have to be strategic about which AI and messaging APIs you choose.

- **Google AI Studio**: Gives you free API access to **Gemini 1.5 Flash**. It has a generous free tier (up to 15 requests per minute), makes decisions quickly, and natively understands text, images, and documents.
- Groq Developer Portal: Provides exceptionally fast, free API access to open-weights models like **Llama 3**. Excellent for text-based customer service chatbots.
- Cohere Dashboard: Offers a free trial API key for their **Command R** models, which are specifically optimized for business tasks, data retrieval, and customer support workflows.

2. The WhatsApp Connection (Free Options)

Meta does not provide an unconditionally free API for WhatsApp. However, you can use these workarounds to deploy your agent for free:

Method	Cost	Best For	How it Works
Official WhatsApp Cloud API	**Free Tier** (First 1,000 service conversations per month are 100% free)	Official business automation	You sign up as a developer on the Meta for Developers portal, link a phone number, and handle incoming messages via webhooks.
Local Gateway Apps	**Free**	Testing & small scale	You install a free Android gateway app (like **Zoko** or **WhatsAuto**) on a spare phone. The app reads incoming WhatsApp notifications and uses your AI API key to reply automatically.
Automated Frameworks	**Free**	Developers / Hobbyists	You use open-source Node.js libraries like **whatsapp-web.js** or **Baileys** hosted on a free cloud server. These libraries control

The easiest way to build this without writing complex backend code from scratch is to use a free visual automation tool:

1. Create a free account on an automation platform like Make.com or Activepieces.
2. Set up a trigger for **"New Message"** using the official **WhatsApp Business** module.
3. Add a step to send that message to **Google Gemini** using a free key from Google AI Studio.
4. Add a final step to **"Send Reply"** back through WhatsApp.

To help you choose the simplest setup, please let me know:

- Approximately **how many customer messages** do you expect to receive per month?
- Do you want to use your **personal WhatsApp number**, or do you have a dedicated **business number**?
- Are you comfortable writing **code** (Python/Node.js), or do you prefer a **no-code/visual tool**?

tell me about openrouter free api solutions of lightweight models

OpenRouter is an incredibly popular API gateway that lets you access multiple AI models using a single OpenAI-compatible API key. **Its selection of 100% free models (with $0 prompt and completion token pricing) makes it highly effective for running lightweight, cost-efficient chatbots like a WhatsApp customer agent.** OpenRouter +3

- **The Free Models Auto-Router (`openrouter/free`):** Instead of picking one specific model, you can point your agent to this endpoint. OpenRouter will **automatically route your request** to a high-performing free model that supports the exact features you need (such as text, images, or tool calling). It supports up to a massive 200,000 token context window.
- **Manual Model Selection:** If you want consistent agent behavior, you can hardcode a specific model whose ID ends in `:free`. OpenRouter +3

2. Best Lightweight Free Models for a WhatsApp Agent

Because customers expect fast replies, you need **lightweight, high-throughput models** that process tokens quickly. The best options available in OpenRouter's free tier collection include: OpenRouter

Model Name & ID	Best For	Key Strengths
MiniMax M3.1 Flash (free) `minimax/minimax-m3.1-flash:free`	**Fast Customer Support**	Consistently one of the most highly-utilized free models on the platform; perfect for speedy text generation.
NVIDIA Nemotron 3.5 Lightning (free) `nvidia/nemotron-3.5-lightning:free`	**High-Volume Automation**	Explicitly designed for ultra-high-throughput agentic workloads and fast-paced conversations.
NVIDIA Nemotron 3.5 Super VL (free) `nvidia/nemotron-3.5-super-vl:free`	**Multimodal Support**	Ideal if your WhatsApp customers send **images, screenshots, or documents** alongside text.
Google Gemma 4 (free) `google/gemma-4-26b-a4b:free`	**General Reasoning**	A highly optimized lightweight option from Google built for sharp, natural dialogue.

- **Free Account Limits:** If you sign up without adding a credit card, you are restricted to **20 requests per minute (RPM)** and **50 requests per day (RPD)**. *(For a low-volume or testing environment, this works perfectly.)* OpenRouter +1
- **The $10 Life-Upgrade:** If your WhatsApp agent starts hitting the daily limit, you can buy a one-time block of **$10 in platform credits**. Even if you never spend those credits on paid models, this action permanently lifts your free-model tier to **1,000 requests per day**. klymentiev.com +2

4. How to Implement it with WhatsApp

Because OpenRouter uses the exact standard **OpenAI API format**, it integrates seamlessly into messaging pipelines. OpenRouter

If you use a visual tool like Make.com, you simply use the standard **OpenAI "Create a Completion" module**, change the API Base URL to `https://openrouter.ai/api/v1`, paste your OpenRouter API Key, and input `openrouter/free` as the model name. OpenRouter +1

Would you like help setting up the **system prompt** for the free model so it speaks like a professional customer service rep, or would you like to look at a **Node.js/Python code snippet** showing exactly how to connect OpenRouter to a WhatsApp webhook?

Free Account Limits: If you sign up without adding a credit card, you are restricted to 20 requests per minute (RPM) an...

No, the limits are shared globally across your entire account and all free models combined. Fastio

Generating multiple API keys or switching between different free models (like changing from Gemini to Llama) will **not** bypass or multiply this limit. Fastio

How OpenRouter Calculates Your Free Quota

- **Account-Wide Cap:** OpenRouter's platform tracker watches your total API key usage. Whether you send 50 requests to a single model, or 1 request each to 50 different models, you will hit the **50 requests per day (RPD)** wall all the same. OpenRouter +1
- **Per-Minute Bottleneck:** The **20 requests per minute (RPM)** constraint also applies account-wide. If you have 3 different WhatsApp users messaging your agent at the exact same second, it counts as 3 requests against that 20-RPM limit. klymentiev.com +1

Strategies for a WhatsApp Agent

Because 50 messages a day can easily be used up by just a few talkative customers, you have two clear paths forward:

1. **The $10 Lifecycle Hack:** If you drop a one-time payment of **$10 into your OpenRouter credit balance**, your daily cap permanently expands to **1,000 requests per day** across all free models. You do not actually have to spend that $10; as long as the credits sit in your account history, you get 1,000 free replies

Would you like help choosing between **purchasing the $10 baseline credit** on OpenRouter or switching over to a **direct Google AI Studio API setup** for your WhatsApp agent?

do we another free platform which give free api ?

Yes, there are several excellent alternative platforms that provide free developer API keys without OpenRouter's 50-request-per-day account restriction. Medium · Gul Jabeen +1

By switching to these specialized providers, your WhatsApp customer agent will get significantly higher daily request caps to handle active customer

- **Google AI Studio**: This is the most generous option available. It gives you a free API key for **Gemini 1.5 Flash** with a massive limit of **1,500 requests per day** and 15 requests per minute. It also features a 1-million-token context window and handles text, customer images, and document uploads flawlessly. Eden AI +1
- Groq Developer Portal: If your WhatsApp agent needs to respond instantly, Groq is the fastest free platform available. Its free tier supports open models like **Llama 3/4** and gives you a generous allowance of **14,400 requests per day**. Eden AI +2
- **Mistral AI (La Plateforme)**: Mistral offers an "Experiment" free tier for its lightweight models (like Mistral Nemo or Small) with high daily caps, making it highly reliable for basic text-based customer service routing. Eden AI +1

2. High-Speed Infrastructure Alternatives

If you prefer the flexibility of open-weights models (like Llama, Qwen, or Gemma) running at blistering speeds, these specialized developer platforms provide direct free access: YouTube · The Code City +1

- Cerebras Systems: Known for generating AI text at thousands of tokens per second, Cerebras offers free API keys for models like **Llama 3.3 70B** and **Qwen** with highly permissive free tiers meant for developers launching applications. Eden AI
- SambaNova Cloud: Another ultra-fast inference platform that provides a free tier for running top-tier open models with standard OpenAI-compatible endpoints. GitHub
- **SiliconFlow**: Provides free API access to over a hundred open-source models (including DeepSeek and Qwen variants) with generous daily allocations for developer prototypes. GitHub +1

How to use them in your WhatsApp Agent

Because almost all of these platforms use the exact same **OpenAI-compatible code structure**, switching your WhatsApp agent from OpenRouter to one of these is incredibly easy. You only need to change two variables in your webhook script or

Which alternative looks best for your WhatsApp agent? I can give you the **exact URL, Base URL, and code setup** for either **Google AI Studio (Gemini)** or **Groq (Llama)** to get your agent running with a higher daily limit today. GitHub +1

SiliconFlow: is this completely free?

No, SiliconFlow is not *completely* free, but it has a massive, permanently free tier that is exceptional for developers. Price Per Token

Instead of capping your entire account like OpenRouter does, SiliconFlow divides its

- **The Models:** This includes popular lightweight models like `Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct`, `DeepSeek-R1-Distill-Qwen-7B`, and various embedding/OCR models.
- **The Rate Limits:** Free models have a fixed rate limit, but it is vastly more generous than OpenRouter's 50-messages-a-day cap. Standard free models allow up to **1,000 requests per minute (RPM)**, meaning your WhatsApp agent can easily handle hundreds of active customer chats concurrently without hitting a wall. GitHub +2

2. The Paid "Pro" Models (Pay-As-You-Go)

Larger, premium models (like top-tier llama variants or FLUX image generation) are paid on a **pay-per-token or pay-per-image** basis. SiliconFlow +1

- When you sign up, SiliconFlow gives you a small **starter credit** (typically about **$1.00 / ¥16**). This lets you test the paid models for free until the credit runs out. Price Per Token +1

Summary for Your WhatsApp Agent

If you connect your WhatsApp agent to one of SiliconFlow's designated **free models** (like Qwen or DeepSeek Distill), **it will be 100% free for your usage level**. You do not need to add a credit card to access these free models, and you won't have to worry about a strict 50-reply-per-day restriction. Price Per Token +2

Would you like the **exact endpoint URL and model IDs** for SiliconFlow's free tier so you can copy them right into your chatbot configuration?

If you connect your WhatsApp agent to one of SiliconFlow's designated free models (like Qwen or DeepSeek Distill), it wi...

Yes, these models are exceptionally good for conversational use and sound highly natural. They are not "toy" models; they are production-grade AI engines capable of acting as professional business assistants. Get Model Key

However, because you are building a **WhatsApp agent for customer service**, you need to understand the structural differences between **Qwen** and **DeepSeek Distill** to choose the right one. They have completely different "personalities" and use cases:

1. The Qwen Series (Highly Recommended for WhatsApp Agents)

Models like **Qwen3-8B-Instruct** are specifically optimized for chat, roleplay, and customer assistance. Get Model Key

- **Why it's great for conversations:** Qwen is tuned to sound incredibly polite, empathetic, and fluid. It handles everyday chit-chat, answers FAQ questions, and writes business replies flawlessly.
- **Speed:** It is highly lightweight and responds almost instantly. WhatsApp users expect immediate answers, and Qwen delivers low-latency replies.
- **Multilingual:** It has top-tier support for multiple languages, making it excellent if your customers message you in languages other than English.

will handle it much better than Qwen. SiliconFlow

- **The Downside for WhatsApp:** Before giving an answer, reasoning models output a `<think>` block where they literally talk to themselves to figure out the answer. If you pass this straight to WhatsApp, your customer will see a massive, messy wall of internal AI thought text before getting their actual reply.
- **Speed:** Because it stops to "think," it takes a few seconds longer to start generating its final answer.

Direct Comparison for Your Agent

Feature	Qwen Chat (e.g., Qwen3-8B)	DeepSeek Distill (e.g., R1-7B)
Tone & Style	**Natural, casual, warm, and highly conversational.**	**Analytical, precise, and fact-focused.**
Response Speed	Ultra-Fast (Near-instant text streaming).	Slower (Takes time to process thoughts).
Best WhatsApp Task	Greeting customers, booking appointments, answering FAQs, taking orders.	Troubleshooting tech problems, calculating quotes, parsing complex requests.

The Verdict for Your Project

For a standard WhatsApp customer agent, **you should use the Qwen chat models**. They feel like you are texting a real, helpful human support agent, and their responses don't carry the awkward structural formatting of a reasoning model.

Would you like the **precise API model strings** for SiliconFlow's free Qwen models, or a **sample system prompt** you can use to force the AI to keep its WhatsApp replies brief and professional?

Meta's pricing changed on 1 October 2026. The current reported allowance is 1,000 free service messages per ...

To integrate SiliconFlow's free conversational models into your WhatsApp agent while working within Meta's **1,000 free monthly service message allowance**, configure the connection details below. Zendesk +1

1. API Connection Details

SiliconFlow utilizes an OpenAI-compatible structure, allowing you to use standard HTTP libraries or native OpenAI SDKs by replacing the base URL and API key: SiliconFlow +1

- **Base URL:** `https://siliconflow.cn`
- **API Key:** Generate yours directly from your SiliconFlow Developer Dashboard.
- **Authentication Header:** `Authorization: Bearer YOUR_SILICONFLOW_KEY`

- `Qwen/Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct` *(Highly Recommended)*
  - **Why:** This is the ideal lightweight model for customer service. It is optimized for chat formatting, reacts with minimal latency to keep WhatsApp users engaged, and has strong multi-language support. SiliconFlow
- `Qwen/Qwen2.5-14B-Instruct`
  - **Why:** A slightly larger model option that handles nuance and multi-turn product FAQs with higher precision while remaining part of the free-tier collection.

Avoid using `DeepSeek-R1-Distill-Qwen` *variants for direct customer replies unless you programmatically strip out the internal* `<think>` *text, as reasoning models will text their internal monologue directly to your customers' WhatsApp screens.* Price Per Token

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3. Quick Code Implementation (Python Example)

If you are writing a custom webhook for WhatsApp to handle incoming user messages, implement the request payload as follows:

python

```python
import requests

def get_customer_reply(customer_message):
    url = "https://siliconflow.cn"

    headers = {
        "Authorization": "Bearer YOUR_SILICONFLOW_API_KEY",
        "Content-Type": "application/json"
    }

    payload = {
```

```
            "role": "user",
            "content": customer_message
        }
    ],
    "temperature": 0.7,
    "max_tokens": 250
}

response = requests.post(url, json=payload, headers=headers)
if response.status_code == 200:
    return response.json()['choices'][0]['message']['content']
return "Sorry, I am having trouble processing that right now."
```

Use code with caution.

💡 Multi-Agent WhatsApp Automation Tip

Because Meta charges individually for *every* service message once you pass the 1,000-message boundary, instruct your **System Prompt** to avoid sending multiple separate messages (e.g., separating "Hello!" from the actual answer). Consolidating the AI's greeting, the response, and any follow-up questions into **one single cohesive WhatsApp block** preserves your monthly free message allowance. Zendesk +1





